

Zifan Chen

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EDUCATION

Boston University, Boston, USA

Expected-June 2026

Master of Science in Applied Business Analytics

Relevant Courses: Quantitative and Qualitative Decision-Making, Enterprise Risk Analytics, Data Mining for Business Analytics, Neural Network for Business Applications, Data Science with Python & Foundations of Machine Learning

University of Toronto (Scarborough), Toronto, Canada

June 2023

Honours Bachelor of Arts in International Development Studies & Public Policy

Relevant Courses: Economic Aspects of Public Policy, Project Management II, Statistics for the Social Sciences, Public Policy Making, Political Economy of International Development, Rational Choice & International Cooperation

ACADEMIC RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Financial Risk and Policy Response Under the U.S. Reciprocal Tariff Framework: The Canadian Outlook and Chinese Banking Strategy

Researcher, associated with Bank of China

Mar 2025 – Present

- Assessed retaliatory trade measures from Canada and quantified sectoral exposure in key industries including automotive, energy, and manufacturing.
- Evaluated fiscal risk by reviewing historical debt trajectories (2015–2024) and interest cost projections across federal and provincial governments.
- Identified credit and operational risks for Chinese banks in Canada, proposing risk control measures for syndication lending, provisioning, and post-loan management.
- Developed response strategies for Chinese financial institutions, including trade finance expansion, RMB cross-border services, and outbound investment support.

Assessing the Economic Impact of U.S. Tariffs on Canada

Researcher, associated with Bank of China

Jan 2025 – Mar 2025

- Analyzed historical trade data (2019-2023) to assess the impact of past and upcoming U.S. tariffs on Canadian trade flows, key industries, and supply chains.
- Led statistical modelling efforts to project GDP contraction, employment shifts, and inflationary risks under a 25% tariff scenario.
- Evaluated economic and diplomatic implications, formulating policy recommendations on trade risk mitigation and diversification strategies.
- Compiled research findings into policy briefs and presentations to inform stakeholders, including financial institutions and trade policy analysts.

Toronto Center of Learning & Development

Jan 2023 – Apr 2023

Team Leader

Course: Community-centered Media Tactics for Development Advocacy and Social Change

- Identified underlying causes of low program participation rates and developed strategic business plans, improving organizational effectiveness and participant engagement.
- Redesigned program structures and optimized scheduling, resulting in substantial improvements in participation rates through targeted adjustments based on stakeholder and participant feedback.
- Established budget planning methodologies and generated detailed project proposals on community outreach, providing a structured approach for future organizational initiatives and funding opportunities.

Sustainable Development Project of Diversified Food Supply Chain in Mountainous Regions of China Dec 2022

Author & Creator

Course: Development Sustainability

- Spearheaded the financial planning and budget allocation for the project, managing a theorized budget of \$2.39 million to enhance food security and agricultural productivity in China's mountainous regions.
- Researched partnership opportunities with municipal and provincial governments, financial institutions, and local universities to secure funding and resource commitments for long-term viability and financial sustainability.
- Developed financial incentives for local and non-local suppliers, including tax cut policies and competitive market strategies, to stimulate economic activity and improve food supply diversity in underserved areas.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Bank of China | Toronto Branch

Toronto, Ontario

Corporate Banking Associate

July 2024 – Present

- Facilitated strategic partnership management by assisting Senior Relationship Managers in expanding a corporate

client portfolio and providing personalized financial solutions, enhancing client engagement.

- Conducted financial analyses in collaboration with the Middle Office & Credit Analysis team, crafting credit proposals that adhered to stringent credit policies and standards.
- Managed a Syndication Loan Portfolio with CAD 400+ million in total, spanning the Gas & Oil, Real Estate, Transportation, IT, and Manufacturing industries, while forming co-ops with Canadian banks like RBC and TD.
- Supported overseas projects on soybean exportation and sustainable energy between Canada and China, giving trade finance solutions and expanding business networks across China, UAE, the US, and Hong Kong SAR.
- Supported key events, including the "BOC Shandong Week," annual board meetings, and will be hosting the 2024 annual celebration, contributing to the international market expansion of the Bank of China Toronto Branch.

Bank of China (Canada)

Markham, Ontario

Customer Service Representative & Bank Teller at GTA Main Branch

June 2023 – July 2024

- Oversaw personal account openings and customer onboarding processes, enhancing compliance with financial regulations through risk management, which significantly increased customer satisfaction and financial security.
- Managed safety deposit box services and spearheaded the Guaranteed Investment Certificate (GIC) program for newly arrived Visa students, facilitating financial integration and ensuring the secure handling of transactions.
- Served as the backup for the Head Teller, managing vault operations and overseeing the China UnionPay PAYBYLINK service for corporate clients, improving financial security in large-scale transaction processing.
- Implemented and enhanced Know Your Customer (KYC) and Anti-Money Laundering (AML) procedures and led branch-level investigations into suspicious financial activities.

Shandong Yulong Gold Co., Ltd.

Mar 2021 – Oct 2021

Intern | International Business Department

Jinan & Shanghai, China

- Coordinated international trade operations and managed document translations, facilitating effective inter-departmental communications and compliance reporting for mining projects across multiple countries.
- Conducted detailed analyses of the international investment environment and geopolitical contexts, authoring comprehensive monthly reports that guided corporate strategy and investment decisions.
- Oversaw the monitoring and management of overseas projects, ensuring the accurate translation and prompt dissemination of essential information to relevant departments for strategic alignment and operational continuity.

OTHER SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Proficient)

Computational Skills: Microsoft Suite, PS, PR

Qualifications: Shanghai Stock Exchange Board Secretary Qualification (Since Aug. 2021)

